



ARMY CONTRACTING
COMMAND- DETROIT
ARSENAL

COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING (CSO) 101 TRAINING

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WELCOMING REMARKS

-  Agenda Overview and Introductions
-  Timing & Schedule
-  Restrooms
-  Emergency Exits
-  Phones & Noise
-  Photography & Recording
-  Questions & Interaction



A PRIMARY TOOL FOR AGILE ACQUISITION & INNOVATION

CSO 101 TRAINING: PURPOSE

- To provide a comprehensive understanding of the expanded CSO process under the FY26 NDAA and how to leverage it as a default tool for acquiring commercial technology.

ACC-DTA Primary Objective
To use CSOs as a faster, more commercial-first acquisition pathway.

AGENDA



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THE REGULATORY FOUNDATION



Definition (DFARS 212.70): A CSO is a merit-based, competitive procedure for acquiring innovative commercial items, technologies, and services.

KEY REGULATORY COMPONENTS				
COMPETITIVE PROCEDURES	BROAD APPLICATION	OPEN ACCESS	CONTRACT TYPE	STRATEGIC INTENT
CSOs are considered competitive, satisfying full and open competition requirements.	Can be used for full life cycle requirements from R&D through sustainment solutions, for advanced component development to complete operational systems.	Open to traditional and non-traditional defense contractors, small businesses, and allied foreign contractors.	Typically results in a fixed-price or fixed-price incentive fee contract.	Reduce barriers to entry for commercial firms and accelerate technology adoption by the warfighter.

THE FY26 NDAA REVOLUTION — KEY CHANGES



The NDAA for FY26, signed into law on December 18, 2025, significantly expanded and streamlined CSOs, cementing them as a primary acquisition tool.

FY26 NDAA UPDATE	DESCRIPTION	IMPACT
EXPANDED SCOPE	Authority now includes all “commercial products, commercial services, or non-developmental items,” not just “innovative” ones.	CSOs for much broader range of requirements, not just cutting-edge tech.
“COMMERCIAL FIRST” MANDATE	CSOs are now the default approach for certain software acquisitions.	Expect use of this pathway frequently for software-defined systems. It is no longer an exception, but the rule.
FLEXIBLE REVIEW OPTIONS	Allows for a mix of peer, technical, or operational reviews, speeding up selection.	We can tailor the evaluation to the need, getting solutions faster.
STREAMLINED FOLLOW-ON	Explicit authority to issue sole-source, follow-on production contracts or OTs from a successful CSO prototype.	CSO may not always result in a follow on but this creates a clear, fast track from a successful prototype to full-scale production, bridging the “valley of death.”
\$100M THRESHOLD REMOVED	The requirement for a written determination from USW(A&S) for contracts over \$100 million is eliminated.	Significantly accelerating awards for larger, more complex projects.

Bottom line: Congress and DoD leadership have empowered you to use this tool extensively.

STRATEGIC BENEFITS FOR THE PROGRAM



Speed to Contract

Expedited selection timeline built into the process, getting critical technology to the warfighter faster. CSO can either be continually open with general Areas of Interest (AoI) or closed for Specific Aols.



Streamlined Compliance

CSOs are contractor-friendly and focus on commercial-style proposals, attracting a wider and more innovative industrial base.



Access to Non-traditional Innovators

Lowering the barrier to entry brings in startups and commercial tech firms that would otherwise not do business with the DoW.



Intellectual Property (IP) Advantage

The process balances industry IP leveraging best commercial practices.

Using a CSO provides advantages for both the government and its industry partners, creating a win-win for acquisition.

RECENT EXAMPLES ACROSS DOW (FY25/26)



CSOs not a niche tool; they are being actively and successfully used across the Department to solve diverse challenges.

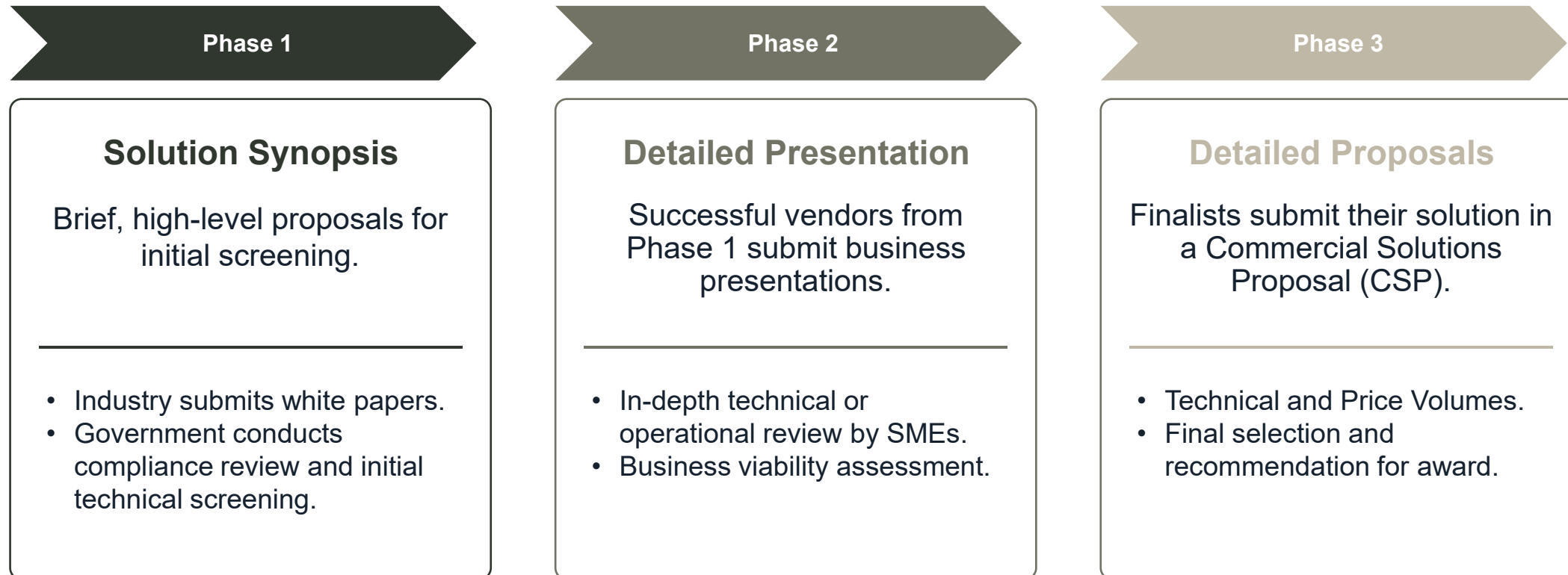
AGENCY/ COMMAND	APPLICATION	KEY TAKEAWAY
Space Development Agency (SDA)	Rapid acquisition of both unclassified and classified space technologies.	Demonstrates CSO effectiveness for high-stakes, technically complex procurements.
SOCOM (US Special Operations Command)	Leveraging the Vulcan platform to issue rapid calls for innovative, operator-focused solutions.	Highlights the agility of CSOs for meeting urgent and specific warfighter needs.
ACC-RRAD	Advanced Manufacturing CSO for domestic component production and scaling.	Our own live example of using CSOs to address critical supply chain and industrial base challenges

Monitor SAM.gov for active CSOs to understand what agencies are seeking in their solicitations.

CSO PROCESS: A STEP-BY-STEP FRAMEWORK



This process is tailored but generally follows a multi-phased approach to down-select to most promising solution.



EVALUATION PROCESS: PEER REVIEW



The term “Peer Review” in a CSO context has a specific meaning and is the core of the technical evaluation.

Peer Review (The Action)

The process of evaluating a proposal’s viability by scientific, technological, or other Subject Matter Expert (SME) peers.

This is NOT the same formal peer review defined in DFARS 201.170.

Peer Reviewer (The Person)

An individual or group of SMEs who performs this technical evaluation to determine the applicability of the proposed solution.

Consistent with evaluations under Broad Agency Announcements (BAAs).

Key principle: Proposals are evaluated individually against the solicitation criteria — not against one another.



EVALUATION PROCESS: ROLE OF THE TECHNICAL TEAM

The technical team (the peer reviewers) drives the evaluation.

The Task

SMEs perform the technical evaluation of each proposal.

The Documentation

A written technical evaluation report is required for each individual proposal.

The Focus

Evaluate the technology, innovation, and applicability to the requirement.

What good documentation should show

- How the proposal was evaluated against the solicitation's criteria
- The characteristics that support or nullify the proposal's merit as a solution
- Enough detail to justify the technical conclusion for each proposal reviewed
- Use of tailored existing agency formats from traditional contracts or BAAs when helpful

Bottom line: the technical report must clearly connect the proposal's merits to the stated need.



EVALUATION PROCESS: ROLE OF THE CONTRACTING OFFICE

While SMEs focus on the technical, the Contracting Office handles the business and compliance aspects.

Price Evaluation

- CSOs are treated as commercial acquisitions under FAR Part 12.
- Standard methods are used to determine fair and reasonable pricing.
- Certified cost and pricing data is not required.

Past performance is not a primary focus when innovative or non-traditional contractors have limited history.

Documentation

- A combined Price Negotiation Memorandum (PNM) and Price Objective Memorandum (POM) may be used.
- Because this is a FAR-based action, standard documentation, reviews, and thresholds still apply to the contract file.

Implication: Technical inputs and the contracting file must stay tightly coordinated.

PROCESS TO AWARD/CLOSEOUT



Possible Outcomes

- Contract Award (single or multiple awards, as permitted).
- No Award / Close Without Award (insufficient value, funding, or mission fit).
- Request Revised Solutions (updated technical/price after exchanges or changed needs).
- Cancel / Amend the CSO (revise scope and request resubmission).

What to Document (Protest-Ready File)

- Evaluation findings tied to the CSO evaluation factors.
- Price reasonableness basis (market research, comps, IGCE, prior buys).
- Record of communications/exchanges.
- Key approvals and complete documentation set.

COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING



CSO/ Areas of Interest	Aol	Important Dates	General Information	Location
Red River Army Depot W911RQ-26-S-C001		CSO Open Through Sept 30. 2026	-Ongoing AOIs: (1) Agile / Flexible Facilities, (2) Connected Digital Enterprise (CDE), (3) Advanced Manufacturing, (4) Paint Process, (5) Automation, (6) Advanced Analytics, (7) Workforce Development, (8) Human Capital, (9) Tire Process, (10) Inventory Process, (11) Energy and Chemical	
Sierra Army Depot W912GY-25-S-C001		CSO Open Through June 30. 2030	-Seeking new capabilities and operational constructs for manufacturing technologies to accelerate the capability to get advanced solutions to the Warfighter while enhancing and optimizing the Defense Manufacturing Base for today and tomorrow's missions.	
Anniston Army Depot W911KF-25-S-C002		CSO Open Through Sept 30. 2030	-Ongoing AOIs: (1) Agile & Adaptive Facilities, (2) Connected Digital Enterprise, (3) Advanced Manufacturing & Maintenance, (4) Automation & Robotics, (5) Process Modernization (e.g., Coating, Surface Treatment), (6) Advanced Analytics, (7) Logistics & Inventory Management Modernization, (8) Workforce Development & Human Capital, (9) Energy, Environmental, and Chemical Management and (10) Depot-Wide Maintenance, Diagnostics, and Parts Modernization	
Watervliet Arsenal W911PT-26-S-C001		CSO Open Through Sept 30, 2027	-Watervliet Arsenal in Watervliet, New York provides a full and open pathway—with no set-asides—for a company to submit innovative commercial technologies that support modernization of the Army's Organic Industrial Base.	
	Advanced Cannon Technologies	August 26, 2026	ACC-WVA is interested in advanced manufacturing methods to compliment or replace the existing bore coating technologies and associated manufacturing processes in large caliber cannon. The use of novel, environmentally friendly, and carcinogenic free technologies is encouraged. Applications of these technologies should be proven and scalable for mass manufacturing.	

COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING



CSO/ Areas of Interest	Aol	Important Dates	General Information	Location
Joint Interagency Agency Task Force 401 (JIATF-401) W912CH-26-S-X001		CSO Open Through Jun 30, 2030	-JIATF 401's focus is on counter Unmanned Aerials Systems (UAS). -This is a broad effort that will consist of many quick action items. Many, though not all, actions will be identified as Aols on the JIATF CSO.	
R&D: GVSC W912CH-24-S-0002		CSO Open Through Jun 04, 2029	- Focus areas include Power and Mobility, Autonomous Systems, Force Projection, Survivability & Protection, Electronics and Architecture, Cyber Engineering and Software Integration, Human Machine Integration, Advance Manufacturing and Modeling, and Simulation and Prototyping. -Specific Areas of Interest (Aols) will be posted as amendments to the CSO as requirements arise.	
ACC-DTA Advancing Strategic Services W912CH-25-S-C001		CSO Open Through June 30, 2026	-Specialized services: information technology (IT) hardware, software, and services; museum exhibit design, fabrication, and installation services; artifact restoration and conservation services; modeling and simulation services; transcription services; custodial services; grounds and facilities services; and other support services.	
	National Museum United States Army (NMUSA) Custodial and Artifact Cleaning Services.	Aol Closes March 16, 2026	ACC-DTA is seeking written solutions to provide continuous, 24/7 custodial, disinfection, and artifact cleaning services at the National Museum of the United States Army (NMUSA) in Fort Belvoir, VA. This work must adhere to the high standards of professionally managed museums, ensuring the protection of the facility and its artifacts.	

COMMERCIAL SOLUTIONS OPENING



CSO/ Areas of Interest	Aol	Important Dates	General Information	Location
Self-Propelled Howitzer Systems (SPHS) Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO)O W912CH-25-S-C002		August 31, 2026	CSO for SPHS for Aol that are directly relevant to enhancing the effectiveness of development, integration, demonstration, and sustainment of ground vehicle systems capabilities to support Army modernization priorities and improve readiness.	
	M109A7 Paladin Breech Mechanism Installed with Breech Reliability `	March 16, 2026	This announcement is seeking a new fabrication approach, feedback on technical drawings, and qualification testing support for the M109A7 Paladin breech mechanism components and/or a cannon assembly.	

CSO/ AOI ON THE HORIZON



CSO/ Areas of Interest	Important Dates	General Information
Common Tactical Truck (CTT)	March 20, 2026	CTT Industry Communication Forum - Registration closes on March 18, 2026 
ISV Heavy	TBD	Contract award planning this FY
Army Watercraft	TBD	Future Support Vessel (FSV) Vessel Bridging System (VBS)

CONCLUSION



The FY26 NDAA has made CSOs a primary, powerful, and permanent tool for acquisition.

Partner early

Success requires a true partnership between the Requirements Owner, the Contracting Office and Industry Partners.

Think commercial-first

Embraces commercial-first mindset to deliver capability to the warfighter at the speed of relevance.

Use us as your acquisition partner

The Contracting Office is here to help — engage early and often.



THANK YOU.

